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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY,KOTTAYAM
MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025
TOURISM ADMINISTRATION AND HOSPITALITY-FIRST SEMESTER
Skill Development Components (SDC) - MG1SDCTAH100- TOURISM PRODUCTS AND PRINCIPLES
(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART- A (Answer any 10 questions that carries 2 marks)

1. Write one line about variability in tourist experiences?
Variability in tourist experiences refers to how each traveler's experience can differ due to factors like culture, expectations, service quality, environment, and personal preferences.
2. List two ways to promote sustainable tourism in desert areas.
   - Use eco-friendly infrastructure, such as solar-powered facilities and water-efficient systems to reduce environmental impact.
   - Encourage community-based tourism, where local people manage tours and activities, helping conserve the desert ecosystem and support local livelihoods.
3. List any two roles of District Tourism Authorities.
   - Planning and developing local tourism facilities and attractions within the district.
   - Promoting and regulating tourism activities to ensure safety, quality, and sustainable practices.
4. What is meant by eco-tourism in mountain regions?
Eco-tourism in mountain regions means travelling to hills or mountain areas in a responsible and environmentally friendly way.
5. What do you mean by amenities in tourism?
The extra services and facilities provided to tourists to make their trip comfortable and pleasant like hotel,travel ,Leisure etc.
6. Mention two elements that influence tourist satisfaction
   - Quality of services
   - Cleanliness and safety
7. What is Intra regional tourism?
Intra-regional tourism means traveling within the same region or within a group of neighbouring countries.
8. Define tourism Infrastructure.
Tourism infrastructure refers to all the basic facilities, services, and physical structures that are necessary for tourists to travel to, stay in, and enjoy a destination.
9. List two significant features of eco-tourism.
   - Conservation of nature
   - Support to local communities
10. Name any two sectors that benefit indirectly from tourism.
   - Agriculture sector – Hotels and restaurants buy vegetables, fruits, milk, meat, etc.
   - Handicraft industry – Tourists purchase local crafts, souvenirs, and traditional products.

11. Give one example of an intangible element in tourism.
Hospitality (friendly behaviour of staff)
12. What is Domestic tourism?
When a person visits places inside their own country (not abroad), it is called domestic tourism.

PART - B(Answer any 4 questions that carries 5 marks)

13. Analyse the concept of the multiplier effect to explain how tourist spending benefits different sectors of the economy.
The multiplier effect explains how the initial spending by tourists produces a greater total income for the economy. As money circulates from tourism businesses to suppliers and workers, it generates employment, demand, investment, and economic development in many sectors—demonstrating tourism's wide-reaching importance to national and local economies.
14. Explain how safety and risk management are important in adventure tourism.
Safety and risk management in adventure tourism protect people, prevent accidents, and make the experience enjoyable and responsible.

- Protects tourists from accidents and injuries
- Builds trust and confidence
- Handles emergencies effectively
- Protects tourism operators and destinations

15. Why are attractions considered the motivators of travel?
Attractions motivate people to travel because they draw tourists' attention and give them a reason to visit a destination.

- Attractions create interest and desire to travel
  Tourists decide to visit a destination because they want to see or experience its attractions—such as beaches, mountains, historical monuments, festivals, or wildlife.
- They give purpose to the trip
  Without attractions, people would have no specific reason to visit a place. Attractions provide the main purpose, excitement, and meaning for the journey.

16. Explain the concept of a composite tourism product with suitable examples.

A composite tourism product is a complete travel experience created by the combination of many different services used by a tourist.When a person travels, they need several services:

- Transport
- Accommodation
- Food
- Attractions
- Activities
- Guides
- Local transport
- Shopping
  All these together form a *composite* (combined) tourism product.

Examples- 1.A holiday package to Goa
Includes: flight + hotel + meals + sightseeing + beach activities.
→ All these elements together form one composite tourism product.

2. A pilgrimage trip to Varanasi
Includes: train journey + accommodation + temple visits + local transport + guide.
→ Many services combined into one travel experience.

17. Discuss the effects of terrorism or safety concerns on tourism decline.

Terrorism or safety concerns can cause a major decline in tourism because tourists always prefer destinations where they feel safe and secure. When a place becomes unsafe, people avoid travelling there.Effects of terrorism or safety concerns on tourism decline as:

1. Decrease in tourist arrivals-Tourists cancel their trips or choose safer destinations, leading to a sharp fall in visitor numbers.
2. Economic losses-Hotels, restaurants, transport services, travel agencies, and local businesses suffer because fewer tourists means less income.
3. Loss of jobs-Many people working in tourism—guides, drivers, hotel staff, shopkeepers—may lose their jobs due to reduced tourist flow.
4. Negative image of the destination-Once a place is labelled as unsafe, it becomes difficult to rebuild its reputation. This long-term negative image discourages future travellers.
5. Higher security costs-Governments and tourism businesses must spend more on security checks, surveillance, and emergency systems, increasing operational costs.
6. Impact on investment- Investors avoid putting money into unsafe regions, resulting in slow tourism development.

18. Analyse how tourism influences local traditions,customs,and community lifestyles.

Tourism has a strong influence on local traditions, customs, and the lifestyle of communities. Its effects can be both positive and negative

Positive influences

1. Preservation of culture-Tourism encourages communities to protect their traditional art, music, dance, crafts, and festivals, because tourists are interested in them.
Example: Folk dances, handicrafts, and rituals are often revived to attract visitors.

2. Economic support for cultural activities-Local people earn money by performing traditional arts, selling handmade products, or organising cultural shows. This gives financial value to their traditions.

3. Cultural exchange-Tourists and locals interact, leading to an exchange of ideas, languages, and knowledge.This improves understanding and openness in the community.

Negative influences

1. Commercialisation of culture-Sometimes traditions are changed or simplified to entertain tourists. This may cause the loss of originality and meaning behind customs.

2. Change in lifestyle-Exposure to modern lifestyles of tourists can influence local people—especially youth—to adopt new fashion, food habits, and values.This may lead to a shift away from traditional ways of living.

3. Cultural conflicts-Differences in behaviour, dress codes, or social norms between tourists and locals can create misunderstandings or cultural tensions.

4. Decline of traditional occupations-As tourism grows, people may leave traditional jobs (like farming or handicrafts) for tourism-related work, causing weakening of old practices.

PART - C(Answer any 2 questions that carries 15 marks)

19. Analyse the various adventure and leisure activities associated with coastal tourism and their impact on local economies.

Adventure and leisure activities in coastal tourism attract a large number of visitors, create significant economic benefits, and generate employment and business opportunities. However, to ensure long-term sustainability, coastal tourism should be developed with strict environmental protection and proper management.

Adventure Activities in Coastal Tourism

1. Scuba diving and snorkelling-Tourists explore coral reefs, marine life, and underwater landscapes.

2. Surfing and windsurfing-Coastal areas with strong waves attract surfers from around the world.

3. Jet skiing and parasailing-High-speed water sports that attract young and adventure-seeking travellers.

4. Deep-sea fishing-Tourists go on guided fishing trips in the open sea.

5. Kayaking and canoeing-Safer, eco-friendly activities suitable for families.

Leisure Activities in Coastal Tourism

1. Beach relaxation-Sunbathing, swimming, and walking on the shore.

2. Cruise trips and boat tours-Short cruises, sunset tours, and island-hopping packages.

3. Coastal cultural events-Beach festivals, seafood fairs, and music events attract more visitors.

4. Wildlife watching-Watching dolphins, turtles, and coastal birds provides a calm leisure experience.

Impact on Local Economies

Positive Impacts

1. Employment generation

Coastal activities create jobs for:

- Boat operators
- Diving instructors
- Lifeguards
- Hotel and restaurant staff
- Shopkeepers and local artisans

2. Growth of local businesses

Tourists spend money on:

- Food and beverages
- Handicrafts
- Local transportation
- Water-sport equipment rentals
  This boosts income for small and medium businesses.

3. Infrastructure development-Demand for tourism leads to improvements in:

- Roads
- Ports
- Safety services
- Hospitality facilities
  This benefits both tourists **and** local residents.

4. Increased government revenue-Taxes from hotels, cruises, water sports, and entry fees increase government income, which can be used for further development.

Negative Impacts (brief)

1. Environmental pressure-Overcrowding can damage coral reefs, beaches, and marine ecosystems.

2. Seasonal dependency-Coastal tourism mostly peaks during certain seasons; income becomes unstable during off-season.

3. Rising living costs-Tourist hotspots sometimes become expensive for local residents due to rising land and food prices.

20. Discuss in detail the role of tourists in the tourism system and how their behaviour shapes destinations.

Tourists play a key role in the tourism system because they create demand, influence development, and shape the economic, environmental, and cultural character of destinations.

Tourists are the central element of any tourism system. Without tourists, there would be no demand for attractions, facilities, or services. Their behaviour, choices, and expectations directly influence how tourism destinations develop and operate.

1. Tourists as Demand Creators

Tourists create demand for:

- Accommodation
- Transport
- Food and beverages
- Attractions and activities
- Shopping and entertainment

This demand drives the growth of hotels, restaurants, travel agencies, and local service providers.

2. Tourists Influence Destination Development

Tourist preferences determine how destinations evolve. For example:

- If tourists prefer adventure activities, the destination develops trekking routes, water sports, or adventure parks.
- If tourists are interested in culture and heritage, the destination invests in museums, cultural shows, and preservation of monuments.

3. Tourists Impact the Local Economy

Tourist spending supports:

- Local businesses
- Employment
- Community income
- Government revenue (taxes, entry fees)

4. Tourists Influence Environmental Conditions

Tourist behaviour affects the natural environment:

Positive behaviour

- Following eco-friendly practices
- Avoiding littering
- Respecting wildlife
- Supporting conservation initiatives
  This helps preserve the destination for future generations.

Negative behaviour

- Overcrowding
- Waste generation
- Pollution of beaches, forests, or heritage sites
- Damage to natural resources
  Such behaviours lead to environmental degradation and loss of attraction value.

5. Tourists Shape Local Culture and Society

Tourists bring new ideas, lifestyles, and cultural exchanges.

Positive effects

- Promotion of local art, dance, crafts, festivals
- Cultural exchange and understanding
- Strengthening of community identity

Negative effects

- Commercialisation of traditions
- Cultural conflicts
- Changes in youth behaviour and lifestyle

6. Tourists Influence Destination Image

What tourists share through:

- Reviews
- Social media
- Word of mouth
  creates the **public image** of a destination.

A positive experience → promotes the destination
A negative experience → harms its reputation

7. Tourists Affect Sustainability

Responsible tourists support:

- Eco-tourism
- Local communities
- Ethical travel practices

Irresponsible tourists contribute to:

- Overtourism
- Resource depletion
- Habitat destruction

21. Write an essay on the significance of promoting India's unique tourism products for global competitiveness and sustainable growth.

Promoting India's unique tourism products is essential for enhancing global competitiveness and achieving sustainable growth. By focusing on what makes the country special—its heritage, culture, landscapes, spirituality, and traditions—India can attract diverse tourists, support local economies, safeguard its environment, and maintain its cultural identity. As global travellers seek authentic and meaningful experiences, India's unique offerings provide unparalleled opportunities for long-term, sustainable tourism development.

1. Enhancing Global Competitiveness

a. Differentiation in a competitive world

Many countries offer beaches, mountains, and cities, but India stands out with its:

- Rich cultural heritage
- Ancient spiritual traditions
- Ayurveda and wellness therapies
- Diverse landscapes ranging from the Himalayas to coastal regions
- Vibrant festivals and cuisines

Promoting these unique products helps India stand apart in a crowded global market.

b. Boosting India's international image

Showcasing world-class attractions such as:

- Taj Mahal
- Varanasi
- Kerala backwaters
- Rann of Kutch

- Wildlife sanctuaries
  creates a strong identity and positions India as a must-visit global destination.

c. Attracting niche and high-spending tourists

Promoting specialised tourism products—like adventure tourism, medical tourism, heritage tourism, eco-tourism, and culinary tourism—helps attract travellers willing to spend more, thereby increasing foreign exchange earnings.

2. Driving Sustainable Economic Growth

a. Generating employment and livelihoods

Tourism is one of India's largest employment generators. Promoting unique tourism products:

- Creates jobs in hospitality, transport, handicrafts, and services
- Provides income opportunities in rural and tribal areas
- Encourages local entrepreneurship

This supports inclusive and balanced regional development.

b. Boosting local economies by supporting crafts and traditions

India's unique cultural tourism promotes:

- Handicrafts
- Traditional arts
- Local cuisines
- Communities involved in heritage conservation

This helps preserve traditions that might otherwise disappear while providing steady income to artisans.

c. Encouraging investment and infrastructure development

When India promotes its world-class tourism assets, it attracts both domestic and foreign investment. This leads to:

- Better roads, airports, sanitation, and accommodation
- Increased safety and tourist-friendly services
  These improvements benefit both tourists and local residents.

3. Supporting Environmental and Cultural Sustainability

a. Preservation of natural resources

Promoting eco-friendly tourism products like wildlife tourism, Himalayan trekking routes, and coastal tourism encourages:

- Conservation of forests, rivers, and wildlife
- Regulation of tourist activities
- Responsible travel practices

This protects fragile ecosystems.

b. Conservation of heritage sites

When heritage tourism is promoted, the government and communities invest more in:

- Restoration of monuments
- Protection of archaeological sites
- Maintenance of cultural landscapes

This ensures India's heritage is preserved for future generations.

c. Promoting responsible tourism behaviour

Highlighting India's unique products encourages:

- Community-based tourism
- Low-impact travel
- Respect for local culture and environment

This reduces negative impacts often caused by mass tourism.

4. Strengthening India's Soft Power and Global Presence

Tourism promotion enhances India's global visibility by:

- Strengthening cultural diplomacy
- Showcasing Indian values of hospitality ("Atithi Devo Bhava")
- Building cultural relationships with other nations

A strong global tourism image contributes to India's overall international influence.